



OUR HOME SELLING DIFFERENCE

Melissa Shaw
FOUNDER OF LEWIS REALTORS
REAL ESTATE EXPERT
LICENSED IN OR & WA

Hello HOME SELLER...



Welcome to Lewis Realtors, where exceptional real estate service meets unwavering commitment to integrity, expertise, and results. Our creative, results-driven marketing approach is tailored to achieve YOUR desired real estate outcomes.

Melissa Shaw

Founder of Lewis Realtors
Serving Portland, OR, Mid - Willamette
Valley and the Vancouver, WA Areas

Making Your Move *Happen*TM

Welcome

Selling your home is more than a transaction – it’s a transition. It’s about closing one chapter and stepping confidently into the next. Our goal is to make that process as smooth, informed, and rewarding as possible. From our first conversation to the final signature at closing, you’ll always know what’s happening, why it matters, and what comes next.

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Our Team & Process

Meet THE TEAM



Melissa Shaw

Founder of Lewis Realtors
Principal Broker in Oregon
Managing Broker in Washington

Melissa consistently gets the job done, following through in a professional, friendly, and efficient manner. With over two decades of real estate experience, she has sold more than \$116 million in home volume since 2016 and has served over a thousand buyers and sellers.

Detail-oriented, naturally attentive, and dedicated to problem-solving, Melissa employs keen negotiating skills and takes a proactive approach to ensure smooth transactions for her clients, always grounded in a deep understanding of her clients' unique personal and financial needs.



Tera Harder

Licensed Real Estate Broker In Oregon

Tera Harder isn't just a real estate broker—she's a trusted advocate who puts her heart and soul into every client relationship. Drawing from her background in special education, she brings a deep sense of empathy, patience, and problem-solving to every home search or sale. Tera ensures that her clients feel heard, supported, and confident every step of the way.

Detail-oriented and highly organized, Tera anticipates challenges before they arise, keeping everything on track with precision and care. More than just a skilled negotiator, she is a warm and compassionate guide, fully invested in her clients' success. Tera is the kind of professional you can trust—someone who will go above and beyond to not only meet your real estate goals but to make the journey into your next chapter enjoyable and rewarding.

Meet THE TEAM



Lisa Neef

Principal Broker in Oregon
Transaction Coordinator

Lisa loves real estate and is passionate, reliable, and detail-oriented. She opened her own transaction coordinator company in 2013 and assists Melissa and her clients by facilitating administrative tasks, managing documents, and monitoring deadlines throughout the purchase and sale processes.



Lora Reed

Creative/Client care & Administrative
Support

Lora works behind the scenes, completing various valued tasks to support a thoughtful client care experience, from gift preparations and client moving book arrangements to addressing back-office administrative needs. She plays an integral role in enabling Melissa to operate efficiently and meet the elevated service and experience standards for each and every client.

*We believe service is
non-negotiable*



Our Mission

We help clients live their best lives through real estate—building wealth, strengthening communities and creating lasting legacies.

Our Core Values

Live Your Best Life

We value wellness, growth, and fulfillment for all we serve.

Integrity First

We lead with honesty, professionalism, and trust.

Elevated Service

We exceed expectations through expert, caring service.

Relationship-Driven

We prioritize genuine connections and community.

Generational Impact

We help create wealth and legacies for the future.

What

WE ARE KNOWN FOR...

- ✓ Timely communication & responsiveness.
- ✓ Full-service listing support—only paid when your home closes.
- ✓ Market insight and home enhancement advice.
- ✓ Proactive marketing strategies, custom video, and professional media.
- ✓ Expert negotiation, market updates, and showing feedback.
- ✓ Commitment to maximizing your proceeds/desired outcomes with attention to detail and creative solutions.
- ✓ Working with integrity

22+

Years of Experience
(13 years more than peers)

102%

AVG. LIST TO SALE
PRICE RATIO
(2% above market)

23

AVERAGE DAYS
ON MARKET
(44% less than peers)

116+

Million Sold
(Since 2016 alone)



Fulfilling the needs of
our clients with
competence and care



Unexpected extras
and elevated
experiences

Full-Service Excellence

Going beyond your expectations before, during and after the transaction to deliver an extraordinary experience.

Giving Back

At Lewis Realtors, serving our community goes far beyond real estate. We believe home is more than a place . . . it's the people, neighborhoods, and shared moments that make it special. That's why we take pride in giving back through charitable programs and local events.

Homes for Heroes - Exclusive Benefit For Local Heroes

Melissa is a an affiliate real estate specialist with a national program called Homes for Heroes® so she can pay it forward to her local heroes after over 2 decades serving her clients in her real estate market.



Serving Others
is at the Heart of
What We Do

Lewis Loves is a movement dedicated to serving others with compassion, dignity, and connection of truly being seen and needs met.

Whether we're honoring heroes, gathering neighbors to celebrate seasonal traditions, or finding new ways to uplift those around us, giving back is at the heart of what we do. Because helping you make your move happen also means helping our community thrive.



AS YOUR LISTING AGENT

We take care of all the details, large and small.

**Conduct a
Comparative Market Analysis**

**Competitively price
your home to sell**

**Create a complete home
marketing plan**

Coordinate showing times

**Negotiate all your offers
per your instructions**

**Provide complete
transaction management**

**Keep you informed
every step of the way**

- Research MLS sales activity.
- Research Days on Market for similar properties.
- Complete curb appeal assessment.
- Discuss how qualified buyers will be vetted.
- Explain brokerage's role in the transaction.
- Measure total square footage.
- Compile list of completed repairs and items to be maintained.
- Order your For Sale signs.
- Assess interior decor and suggest changes.
- Discuss print and online ads.
- Design property marketing flyers.
- Create buyer feedback report.
- Review MLS regularly to ensure property remains competitive.
- Notify my referral network about your listing.
- Provide weekly progress reports and share feedback to determine if any changes are needed.
- Create a net sheet to evaluate offers.
- Explain pros and cons of each offer.
- Establish a timeline for loan approval and closing.
- If needed, order and supervise inspections including lead paint, asbestos, well, mold and sewer systems.
- Confirm earnest money deposit.
- Verify with buyer's agent that loan processing is on track.
- Help resolve any issues with buyer after the sale.



Here to Help

Rely on our list of pros

Consider us your source of referrals for all types of businesses, whether related to real estate or not. We have partnered with competent professionals who would be happy to serve you:

- **Transaction related:** Lenders, legal professionals, closing agents, home inspectors, pest control services, insurance agents (home, auto, health), movers
- **Other business professionals:** Financial planners, tax advisors, doctors, dentists
- **Home repairs and improvements:** Handy persons, general contractors, interior designers, roofers, painters, flooring installers, plumbing/electrical and HVAC specialists
- **Landscape/maintenance:** Yard and pool services, house cleaners, window washers

If you need a referral to a provider that is not mentioned here, feel free to ask; we may know just the person you're looking for!

Real estate news you can use

We can provide you with up-to-date information and statistics on local market conditions, which can differ substantially from national market conditions and what you hear in the media.

Maximize resale potential

Feel free to ask for specific advice on home maintenance, or suggestions for upgrades that will enhance your property's resale value.

Community insight

We're always happy to provide information on community amenities such as parks, schools and trails, or even local special events.

Let's talk market value

Request a market analysis when you need an estimate of your home's current value for a potential refinance or for insurance, estate planning or property tax purposes. We're also available to discuss issues or new developments in the community that could affect property values.

Help where ever you need it

We can help you, family member or friend secure the services of a like-minded real estate professional in another part of the country.

Experience MATTERS

Founder & Real Estate Broker, Lewis Realtors

Over two decades of real estate experience, in excess of 1000 home transactions for clients in the Portland, OR & Vancouver, WA Metro Local Markets.

Accredited Luxury Home Specialist (ALHS)

Endorsed member of the Luxury Home Council with advanced training and the skills to assist buyers and sellers with luxury homes. ALHS accreditation enhances marketability and resources available for Melissa's clients.

Accredited Buyer's Representative (ABR)

Extensive real hours and ongoing educational training accomplishing the highest quality of buyer representation for clients covering all the details of the home buying process from initial contact through closing and beyond.

Seller's Representative Specialist (SRS)

Elite designation for realtors extensively trained in a wide variety of manual and electronic marketing methods to uniquely promote your property to the widest range of prospective purchasers and is trained to ensure you receive the best possible outcomes during negotiations.

Certified Real Estate Negotiation Expert (RENE)

Collaborative skilled negotiator with advanced skills from enhanced education and real time hours, critical to a successful transaction and maximizing financial outcomes for clients.

Pricing Strategy Advisor (PSA)

Enhanced skillset in pricing properties and creating CMA's & working with appraisers to guide clients in pricing their properties for maximum exposure in the shortest amount of time for the highest possible price.



Circle of Excellence - Double Platinum is the highest designation obtainable indicating a proven track record of success, closing in excess of 108+ million dollars of real estate since 2016 alone.

Certified Staging Agent (CSA)

Expertly trained and credentialed by a home staging school to showcase your home in its best light.

Certified Full-Service Professional (CFSP)

committed to growth in delivering an industry-leading experience that really wows clients.

Proven consistent endorsements through repeat clients and referrals because relationships and service matter at the highest level in everything we do.

WHY WE WORK BY *Referral...*

Relationships are more important than transactions.

You may have noticed that many real estate agents take a transactional approach to sales - identifying clients, closing the deal, and moving on to the next one. We believe you deserve more from the professional you decide to work with. That's why we work by referral.

Since our primary source of new business is referrals from people who know and trust me, we don't have to spend time prospecting and promoting. We can dedicate our time fully to the activities that benefit you most and always deliver truly exceptional service.



We know that we must earn your future referrals, so we aim to exceed your expectations.

We have a vested interest in making sure you are completely satisfied with your transaction. We want you to be so “fired up” that you can’t wait to tell your friends and family about us and the fantastic service you received!

When you come across an opportunity, we’d appreciate you referring us to great people like yourself, who would benefit from the excellent service and personal attention we provide.

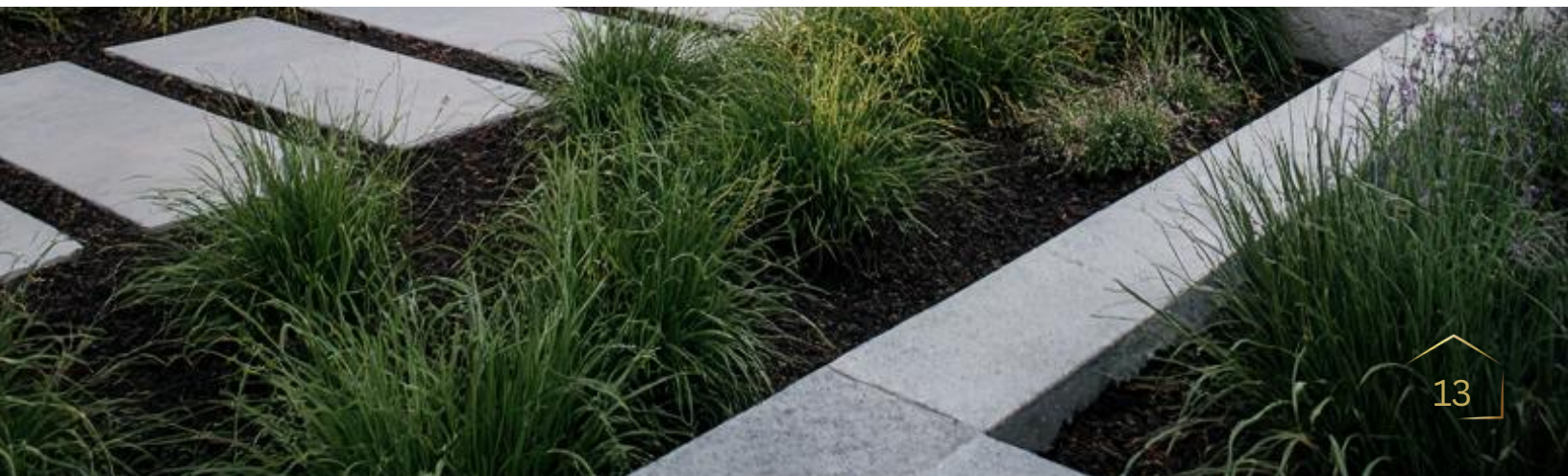
Service that continues after the sale.

We devote ourselves to serving the needs of our clients before, during and after each sale.

Instead of disappearing after the closing, you can expect us to keep in touch. We will send you valuable information each month, and will also call from time to time just to check in and see if you need anything.



www.PortlandRealEstateReviews.com



Client Testimonials



“Melissa served as the listing agent for our property and she was excellent! Very professional, great communication, and organized. We highly recommend her!”

"Melissa has helped me 3 times. Twice buying and one time selling. I would never use anyone else. She truly wants the best for you."

“By far the best realtor I have ever worked with! Melissa is incredibly knowledgeable about the selling and purchasing of homes and she gives 100% for her clients. She has helped us sell twice and buy 2 homes and she made the experience amazing. She took care of everything so we did not have to worry. Melissa is incredible and so is her team. You should stop looking for a realtor and go with Melissa because she is the best!! We have a realtor for life!!”

"Melissa brings to bear a great deal of experience and resources in the selling process, which made the process go more smoothly than it would have otherwise. She has built up an arsenal of professional contacts who contribute to getting the seller the best outcomes possible, and she is an organized and energetic coordinator, who acted on our behalf to keep all the balls in the air and get us to the finish line for closing!"

"Melissa Lewis Realtor has done a fantastic job for us. Buying or selling over the past 20 years plus she is our go to agent!"

“Melissa made the process for first-time home sellers easy, and understandable we really appreciate her taking time to explain every part of the process. There was a lot we hadn't known and a lot we learned thanks to her patience with detailed explanations. When a change or situation arose with the acceptance of an offer, she kept us informed and got the paperwork through. Negotiations were not easy, but Melissa's expertise and understanding of the process got the job done! We highly recommend her!”

"Melissa is an amazing realtor! She has sold 2 homes for us & helped us buy 1 homes. The first home she sold for us was a difficult situation, but she persevered and would not give up! We ended up selling the house for what we needed to and helped us close in a creative way. We bought an amazing house, even during an incredibly competitive market. Melissa knows her stuff and is a great negotiator! When it came time to sell our second home home with her, she helped to sell in in less than a week! This was even during personal trials and it was November (not peak season). She is easy to communicate with and truly a joy to work with."

"I've had Melissa represent me numerous times. Her negotiating skills are impeccable. I've seen her work miracles on my transactions and on the 100's of transactions we have worked on together. I'm very thankful to have her as one of my main resources. Her ethics and morals are a bench mark to reach for. I highly recommend her."

"Melissa's compassion and expertise helped our family though the difficult process of selling the parents home after a medical crisis forced them to move to assisted living. She gave us great advice on how to get the best price in the time allowed. Then throughout the repairs and preparations she answered all our questions and encouraged us to focus our efforts on the most important tasks. Her excellent marketing and negotiation gave us a trouble-free sale at a great price. I hope that by writing this review I can alert others who need extra help selling their house to the best realtor in the business!"

"Melissa goes above and beyond for the people that she helps. Her professionalism and personable personality really caters to everyone's individual needs. The experience you get with Melissa makes the process much smoother as she helps you with every step of the way. She has become someone we can trust and I would recommend her to anyone needing a realtor."

"Melissa was competent, quick, well-connected, and totally on top of every detail that needed attention during the entire process of listing and selling our property. Working with her is a breeze! "

"Knows about market very well. Quick response, intelligent, responsible and detailed."

EVERY STEP TO *Sold!*

- 1** **Meet With Your Agent**
Discuss needs, pricing strategy, and home enhancements.
- 2** **Prepare To Sell**
Deep clean, declutter, repair, enhance curb appeal, and stage the home.
- 3** **Imagery**
Schedule professional photography, videography, drone sessions, floor plans.
- 4** **Marketing Launch**
Launch full online and offline promotion: social media, signage, flyers.
- 5** **Showings**
Ensure the home is prepared for showings and collect agent feedback.
- 6** **Receive and Review Offers**
Present and discuss strategic advice and evaluation of all offers.
- 7** **Negotiate Terms**
Counter-offers, inspections, desired outcomes.
- 8** **Inspections and Appraisal**
Coordinate buyer inspections and appraisal processes.
- 9** **Repairs**
Negotiate, schedule, and manage necessary repairs.
- 10** **Closing**
Sign documents, transfer utilities, record, collect keys, remotes, and move!



Preparing & Packing

Pre-Pack and Declutter

Pre-packing, decluttering and removing things you are not using on a daily or frequent basis will make your move easier.

As a rule, the more floor, counter, and decorating space you can see the better. This will allow potential buyers to spatially conceptualize their personal items in the home without the distraction of your personal belongings.



Tip 1

If you find it hard to get started, just start with a couple of drawers, or pick the one room with the least number of belongings and start there.

Tip 2

Keep a box out as you start to pack and label it “OPEN FIRST”; these are important items you will need first to save you searching and you’ll also want to keep it with you and accessible for easy retrieval. Items you may want to consider packing in your “Open First” box are:

- **Essentials:** toiletries, medications, personal hygiene products
- **Basic Tools:** screwdrivers, pliers, utility knife, flashlight for assembly/repair
- **Important Documents:** identification documents, passports, rental agreements, moving-related paperwork
- **Basic Kitchen Supplies:** a few dishes, cups, utensils, a pot, hand towels, hand soap, a pan, non-perishable snacks, instant coffee or tea bags
- **Bedding:** sheets, pillows, blankets for the first night
- **Clothing:** pajamas for the first night and comfortable clothes for the next day
- **Chargers:** for your phone, laptop, and any other essential electronics
- **Basic Cleaning Supplies:** paper towels, toilet paper, soap, disinfectant wipes, a small bottle of all-purpose cleaner
- **Child/Pet Necessities:** diapers, formula, baby food, pet food, toys
- **Emergency Kit:** basic first aid kit with bandages, pain relievers, any necessary medications.

Home Enhancements

Ultimately what you do will depend on your budget, the current condition of your home, what you are willing to do and whether you want to maximize profit potential or limit your time and effort before selling. As a rule, removing any question marks or deferred maintenance for potential buyers is a sound investment.

The National Association of Realtors (NAR) often recommends several updates to a home before selling it to increase its appeal to potential buyers and potentially boost its value. Here are some common recommendations:

Decluttering

Decluttering is the most common home improvement task recommended to sellers by agents, with a recommendation rate of 96% & is a double bonus as when you declutter you are already starting to stage which is a lucrative strategy for selling your home for more with less days on market. Home cleaning was the second-most recommended task.

Curb Appeal Enhancements

First impressions matter. Improving the exterior of the home, such as landscaping, painting, or upgrading the front door, can make a big difference. It is the first thing a potential buyer sees both online and by driving by.

Kitchen Updates

The kitchen is often considered the heart of the home. Upgrading appliances, countertops, cabinets, and fixtures can greatly increase a home's value. In a balanced market this will also set your home above others and sell with less days on market than homes that are not typically updated.

Energy Efficiency Upgrades

Energy-efficient features like LED lighting, smart thermostats, or energy-efficient windows can appeal to environmentally conscious buyers and may lower utility costs that make your home favorable.

Flooring Updates

Replacing old carpet with hardwood floors or other modern flooring options can add value and appeal to potential buyers.

Painting

A fresh coat of paint can make a home feel new and well-maintained. Neutral colors are often recommended to appeal to a broad range of tastes.

Maintenance and Repairs

Address any issues with the home, such as leaky faucets, broken tiles, or outdated electrical systems. A well-maintained home is more likely to sell quickly and for a higher price.

Smart Home Technology

Integrating smart home features like security systems, smart locks, or automated lighting can make the home more attractive to tech-savvy buyers.

Light & Bright

Remove heavy drapery from windows and make sure all light bulbs are the same hue, either all warm lighting or cool lighting

Bathroom Renovations

Updated bathrooms are attractive to buyers. Consider improvements such as new fixtures, tiling, or modernizing the layout.

Home Staging: Costs & Benefits

National Association of Realtors (NAR) statistics show that **home staging has positive impacts** including reduced time on market and higher offers. Staging shows your home at its best and helps buyers imagine themselves living in the space. Staging does involve additional cost, but statistics show a **significant return on investment** for staged homes.

Home staging costs can vary, as the price depends on what services you request. Typically, you choose from reorganizing existing furniture, paying for color consultation services, decluttering and packing, staging a few key rooms, or staging the entire home with rental furniture.

The average cost to stage all the rooms in a vacant house can range from \$2,900 to \$5,250 for initial set up, with a reduced monthly fee going forward. Initial design consultations vary from free to several hundred dollars, and can also vary from location to location. **Contact your real estate agent for recommendations to fine tune the services best suited for you**



Documents That Make A Difference

Property Information

Be prepared to share any recent renovations or upgrades completed and any transferable warranties that would add value since you have purchased the home.

Documentation

Copies of any relevant documents, survey reports, permits for any renovations, additions.

Homeowners Association (HOA) Information

If applicable, provide information about the HOA, including fees, rules, and contact information.

Home Improvements and Maintenance Records

Records of any repairs, or maintenance performed on the property, including dates and receipts.

Wireless/Smart Home Features

Make a list of any passwords, codes or smart home features.

Financial Information

Mortgage information, including the current loan balance and any outstanding liens or loans on the property.

Appliances and Fixtures

Make a list of all appliances and fixtures excluded in the sale, for example light fixtures, and window treatments. Typically, anything that is fixed to the home stays, anything free standing is considered personal property and is negotiable or excluded.

Personal Property Exclusions

If there are any items in the home that you as the seller plan to include in the sale (e.g., fridge, washer, dryer, shelving not fixed to walls) please make a list of these items.





Listing Marketing

Prepare To List

Start to Finish:

- **Listing paperwork** & disclosures signed
- Agent **schedules staging**, if applicable
- Finalize any **packing**
- **Deep clean** home, including window cleaning
- **Stage** home - whether it is professionally done, implemented from a staging consultation, or guided using your own furniture from your real estate professional
- Make **copies of house keys** for your real estate professional
- **Lockbox** installed
- **Booties and listing swag** set up in home
- Agent facilitates **imagery**: professional aerial, interior, exterior, community photography, custom videography, virtual walkthrough, floor plan drawings as applicable
- **Signage** is ordered
- **Marketing materials** designed and sent to seller for review & approval
- Sellers property **disclosures** completed
- **Signage** & marketing materials delivered

*And then . . . your listing
goes **Live!***



PRICE LIKE *Pro* A

Pricing a home correctly is the number one factor in getting it sold in a timely fashion for the highest price. Using a Comparative Market Analysis (CMA) is the best bet for setting your price correctly the first time. Using this CMA, we research sold properties in your area and determine the best listing price for your home. When a home is priced correctly the first time it generally sells quickly since buyers see value and move quickly, sometimes creating a multiple offer situation. A home gets the most traffic when it is first listed so the first listing price is crucial to capturing buyers' attention.

THE PROBLEM WITH LISTING TOO HIGH

PROBLEM 1

exclusion

Inflating the value of your home inadvertently could exclude your property from online search results to those that would be able and willing to pay the actual value for your home.

PROBLEM 2

perception

Due to a lack of interest you may have to later drop the price, causing your house to have the appearance of a distressed property.

PROBLEM 3

appraisal

Even if you are successful in finding someone to pay more for your house, you still need to go through the appraisal process if financed. If the appraisal comes back lower than the agreed upon sales price, the buyers will have difficulty obtaining a loan because lenders won't pay over-market prices.



DETERMINES

the price of your home

- market condition
- comparative sold properties
- current inventory
- property features
- exposure
- location
- condition

DOES NOT DETERMINE

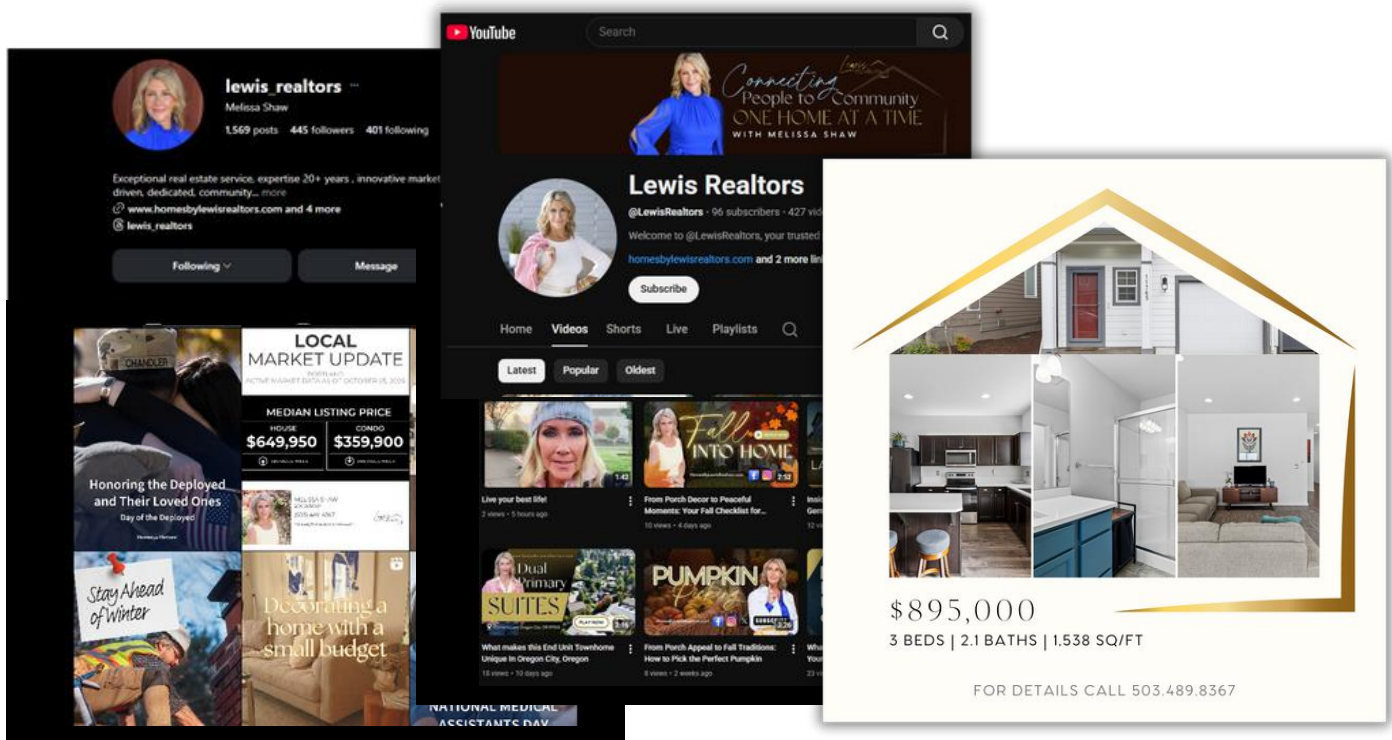
the price of your home

- what you paid for the home
- what online sites think it is worth
- what you need to make on the home

Full Spectrum MARKETING

Our full-service approach uses out-of-the-box digital marketing, tailored directly to showcase the lifestyle, the story, and the unique value of your home. This includes everything from high-end custom video tours, to targeted social media reach, agent-to-agent networking, and carefully crafted online exposure.

Because 51% of your buyers are watching from their screens first, and 29% are in touch with a trusted agent, the smart move is making sure your home shines in the spaces that matter most.

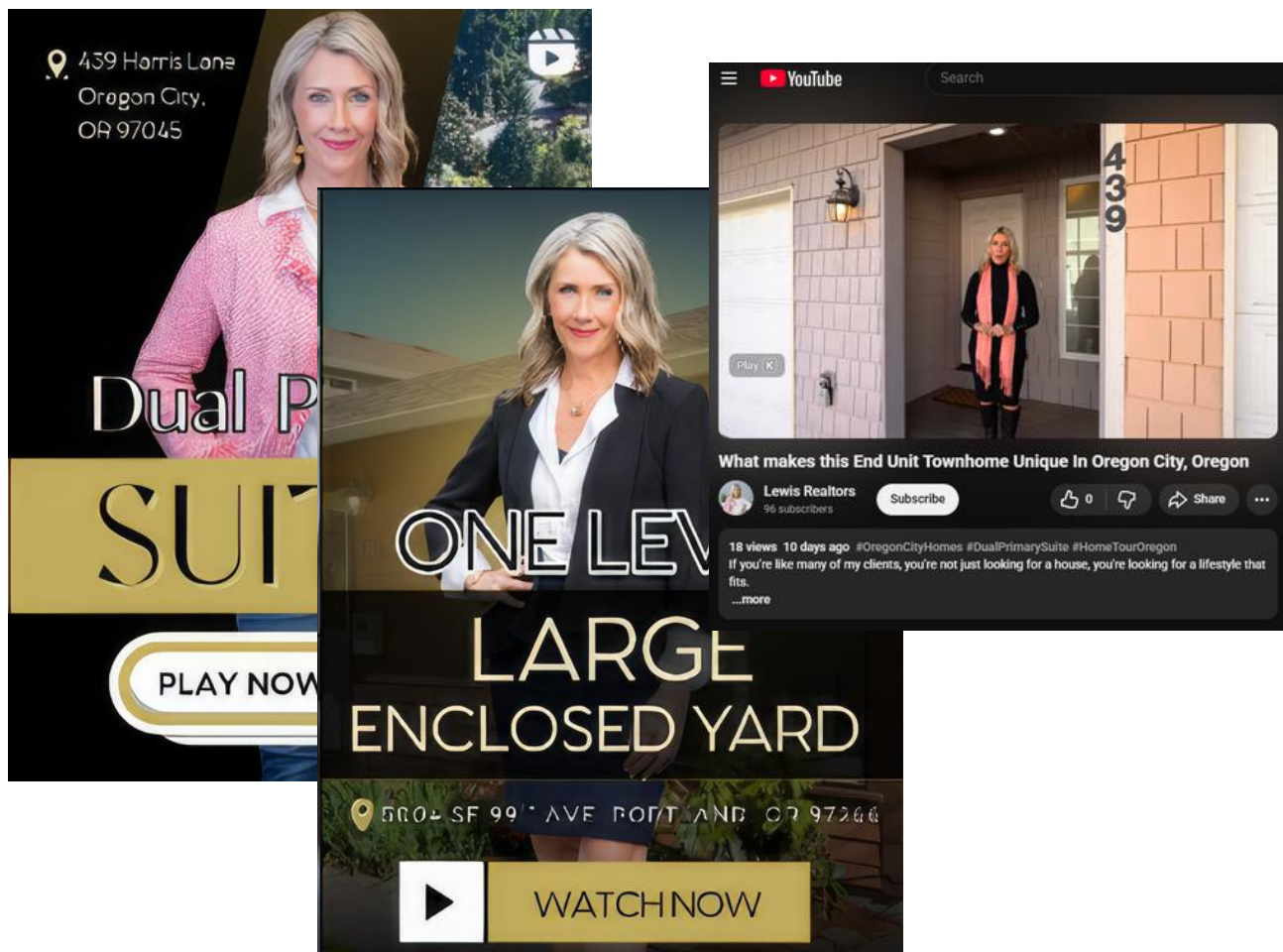


700+
Database
Loyal clients

Custom VIDEOS

At Lewis Realtors, our custom videos go beyond simple listings - they are crafted stories that showcase your home with elevated presentation, polished visuals, and a purposeful narrative. With over 20 years of experience, we combine creative, results-driven marketing with tailored strategy, turning every home into a memorable experience that stands out in the marketplace.

In a market where buyers shop online first, we make sure your home gets the attention it deserves.



Education THROUGH VIDEO

We believe knowledge builds confidence, and confident clients make empowered decisions. That's why we create clear, approachable educational videos that demystify the real estate process and help you feel informed every step of the way. Whether you're preparing to list, navigating offers, or planning your next move, our goal is to provide guidance before you even need to ask . . . so you always feel supported and a step ahead.

Our videos are a reflection of who we are and how we show up in this industry. They highlight the expertise, polish, and professionalism that set Lewis Realtors apart, reinforcing our commitment to excellence and elevating the client experience from day one. Exceptional service isn't just about results, it's about confidence, clarity, and the trust that comes from working with seasoned professionals who lead with education and integrity.



From Listed to SOLD

Step By Step

- Home is **listed** on local Multiple Listing Service (MLS) and officially available
- Custom **marketing plan** is launched
- **Showings** are scheduled
- **Feedback** is requested from showings
- Receive **offer(s)**
- Review offer(s)
- **Terms and conditions** are negotiated
- **Contracts** are agreed on and signed by buyer and seller
- Buyer deposits **earnest money**
- Buyer conducts **home inspection**
- **Repairs** are negotiated, if applicable
- Loan documents are ordered
- Closing documents are signed by buyer and seller
- Loan is funded and recorded
- Sign and marketing materials are removed
- Seller leaves any extra keys/remotes, mail key, smart device passwords and info
- Seller ensures home is clean and all personal property removed unless designated to stay in the contract
- Seller completes move and schedules utilities to end as of closing date





FAQs & Resources

Seller

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

How should I prepare my home for sale?

Set an on-site appointment for your real estate agent to come take a look and provide you with a home enhancement list.

What is my home worth?

A preliminary comparative market evaluation can be created, however for a more serious professional opinion an on site visit is usually required with all the home details and features taken into account along with the neighborhood and community.

Showing Tips

- ✓ Play soft relaxing instrumental music or visually appealing relaxing screen saver on your TV
- ✓ Avoid any strong scents, burning candles, incense & the like
- ✓ Make sure all lights are on and blinds open for as much light as possible
- ✓ Show home as clean as it was for photos

Photo Prep Tips

- Make sure all **light bulbs** are working and are the same hue (all warm or all cool light bulbs)
- Put all **garbage cans**, free standing **fans** out of site!
- Open **window coverings** for light
- Park your **cars** away from the house and down the street
- Complete **prepack** and home enhancement items
- Freshly **deep clean** including windows
- Arrange for **pets** and pet belongings to be away

How long should I be gone for showings?

Plan for 30-60 minutes depending on the size of the property.

Is the seller's agent typically there for buyer showings?

The seller's agent is typically not there for showings. This creates an environment where potential buyers take their time to look at the property and convey their true thoughts to their buyer's agent and ask questions. It is the seller's agent's job to ensure all information is readily available for the buyer's agent, especially regarding unique systems and features of the property, making it easier to answer any potential buyer's questions.

HOME SELLERS: Here's What The NAR Settlement Means For You

As a home seller, you have a wide range of choices when it comes to listing your home. Agents who are REALTORS® are a trusted source of advice and stand ready to help you navigate this complex process and make the choices that work best for you. NAR's recent settlement has led to several changes related to broker commissions that benefit sellers, and we wanted to clearly lay them out for you.

HERE IS WHAT THE SETTLEMENT MEANS FOR HOME SELLERS:

- You still have the choice of offering compensation to buyer's brokers. You may consider doing this as a way of marketing your home or making your listing more attractive to buyers.
- Your agent must conspicuously disclose to you and obtain your approval for any payment or offer of payment that a listing broker will make to another broker acting for buyers.
- This disclosure must be made to you in writing in advance of any payment or agreement to pay another broker acting for buyers, and must specify the amount or rate of such payment.
- If you choose to approve an offer of compensation, there are changes to how this can happen.
- You as the seller can still make an offer compensation, but your agent cannot include it on a Multiple Listing Service (MLS)—MLSs are local marketplaces used by both buyer brokers and listing brokers to share information about properties for sale.
- Your agent can advertise your listing via off-MLS platforms such as social media, flyers and websites.
- You as the seller can still offer buyer concessions on an MLS (for example, concessions for buyer closing costs).

These settlement practice changes went into effect August 17, 2024

HERE IS WHAT THE SETTLEMENT DOESN'T CHANGE:

- Agents who are REALTORS® are here to help you navigate the process of selling your home and are ethically obligated to work in your best interest.
- Compensation for your agent remains fully negotiable, and if your agent is a REALTOR®, they must abide by the REALTOR® Code of Ethics and have clear and transparent discussions with you about compensation. When finding an agent to work with, ask questions about compensation and discuss what you would like to offer buyers.
- You have choices. Work with your agent to understand the full range of these choices when selling your home, which will help you make the best possible decision for your needs.

More details about these changes and what they mean can be found at: facts.realtor



REALTORS® ARE MEMBERS OF THE NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF REALTORS®

BUYER'S AGENTS **How They Help You Sell**

Following the 2024 NAR settlement, sellers can choose whether to compensate buyer's agents as part of a home sale. When making your decision, keep in mind the 'invisible' value buyer's agents provide:



Brings a bigger pool of stronger buyers.



Reduces the number of those “just looking.”



Encourages the buyer to make a fair and strong offer.



Helps expedite the entire process ensuring the deal doesn't fall through and closes on time.



Recommends professionals (mortgage lenders, title, insurance, etc,) to ensure a smooth closing.



Every State Is Different

BEWARE OF YOUR STATE QUIRKS

Washington

Although Washington State does not have an income tax it does have a sales tax and when you sell your home it can be significant. Sales state tax is 1.10% + county tax when selling. Ask your agent for a county breakdown but always consult your tax professional for up to date information.

Oregon

When moving out of state, escrow may be required to hold a portion of the sellers proceeds if the seller is a non-residential individual or corporation. It is recommended that you consult with your tax accountant or CPA and have them fill out a Form OR-18-WC or applicable advised form to provide escrow to avoid any surprise tax withholdings or last minute work for yourself.

In Our Website

This guide is just the beginning . . . you'll find more information and resources including a Home Value Analysis tool, Mortgage Calculator, and seasonal homeowner's checklists at www.HomesByLewisRealtors.com. As a client, you'll also have access to our combined knowledge and network - we're here for you, from first house to forever home!

LINKS

Find these tools and more on the Resources tab at www.HomesByLewisRealtors.com

Home Value Analysis

Enter some basic information about your property and we'll create a custom home value analysis just for you.

Start Here

Mortgage Calculator

Our handy tool to quickly calculate your estimated monthly payment using price, down payment, loan term and interest rate, plus other monthly fees.

Calculate Now

Homeowner's Checklists

Keep your home in top form all year long with our helpful checklists.

Get the Lists

www.HomesByLewisRealtors.com

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